



YOU ARE **26 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

93 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Although some babies open their eyes, this happens only very briefly, so it is difficult to capture on an ultrasound scan. Some light is reaching your baby, but they haven't developed a sleep-wake cycle that corresponds in any way with day and night.

“As each day passes, your baby is getting bigger and bigger and you will be more conscious of his body and movement.”

As wonderful as it is to feel your baby move inside you, sometimes it can be uncomfortable. As your baby grows, there is less and less room for him to move around, especially as he kicks or stretches against the walls of your uterus. These movements can vary from gentle paddling motions to feeling as though the baby has hiccups. Sometimes the baby will kick hard; if it's under the ribs, it can take your breath away and leave you feeling quite sore. The kicking can also wake you when you're sleeping, and many women say that their babies are more active at night. If you're sitting or lying in a position that the baby doesn't like—for example, if you spend too much time on one side—your baby may well kick until you move.

Although sometimes these movements can be uncomfortable or take you by surprise, most of the time they're just a gentle reminder of your growing baby and, as such, are something to look forward to feeling.

ASK A DOCTOR

If I went into labor now, would my baby survive? Until relatively recently, babies born before 28 weeks' gestation often did not survive. Today, with medical advances in neonatal intensive care units (NICU), babies of 22 weeks' gestation have survived outside the uterus, although this is still very rare. At many hospitals, doctors won't resuscitate a baby under 24 weeks, because there is little chance of survival.

Extremely premature babies have an increased risk of disability, even with the best medical care, and often the delivery itself can put an enormous strain on the baby. Very experienced doctors and nurses are involved in the care of extremely premature babies.

If possible, the delivery should take place in a hospital with a neonatal intensive care unit (NICU; see [Baby blues](#) and [Finding your way](#)). If this isn't possible, babies are often transferred to a special center when they are stable enough to be moved. Very premature babies take a long time to “catch up” and meet developmental milestones.